Equip



GOSPEL FLUENCY

What makes someone fluent in a language? How about fluent in the gospel?

How natural is it for your to relate the gospel to your own day-to-day life? Why?

A basic rule of communication is that we are to communicate with others in a way *they* best understand. When sharing the gospel, this often requires us to step out of our natural way of relating in order to meet someone else where they currently are in their understanding of the gospel, rather than where *we* might be in our understanding, or how *we* would like to be communicated with.

Consider the definitions and tool below. Fill out the practice example, then complete an example of your own from an encounter you had this past week!

EXPERIENCE: A specific event or feeling you've had recently. Could span a moment or months.

CONCEPT/WORD: An idea or theme from the gospel / God's Word that is especially good news to you right now in response to that experience. This helps anchor our thinking and experience and narrows it into something specific that can be shared. We grow to interpret our lives through the gospel, not the other way around.

VERSE: Ground that concept/word in the Scriptures by relating it to a verse that God has used in your life (or explains the concept/word well). This also helps subtly introduce God's Word and reveals our daily dependence on it. Hearing you quote Scripture becomes normal to your non-believing friends.

QUESTION: Open up the conversation to your friend or community. This gives the listener a chance to respond and gives you an easy way to discuss the Word.

CONCEPTS FOUND IN THE GOSPEL:

Grace, peace, love, hope, faith, forgiveness, freedom, healing, restoration, reconciliation, redemption, purification, belonging, intimacy, joy, newness, fully known, reborn, understood, tenderness, Father, fullness, complete, pursuit, family, fellowship (with God and people), security, purpose

EXAMPLE: Recently when I've been feeling down on myself for "not doing enough," whether that be in work or pursuing friends while I've been home for Christmas time. God has been reminding me of how gentle he is to me even though I'm weak and inconsistent. There's a cool verse in the Bible that talks about how Jesus "sympathizes with our weaknesses" because he experienced the same trials and temptations as us when he lived on earth. The next verse says that we should draw near to God with confidence so that we can receive mercy and grace when we're in need. So, I've been thanking God that he understands why I'm frustrated and even more so that he wants me to go to him for help. Do you feel like Jesus understands you? / Would you want to see those verses I was talking about? What do you think about them?

EXPERIENCE	CONCEPT/WORD	VERSE	QUESTION
Feeling forgotten by friends, but remembering that God seeks me out constantly	God's pursuit	Isaiah 62:12 "...you shall be called Sought Out, a City Not Forsaken"	Do you think God is pursuing you? /Do you want to see that verse I was talking about?

This journal was made by the University of Arizona Navigators staff in 2020, with the latest update in 2025, and is meant to be shared. Please do not reproduce for profit.

For reproduction, corrections, suggestions for improvement, or to request a digital copy please email Ryan Mullarkey at ryan.mullarkey@navigators.org